Practice workbook · Retrograde and anterograde amnesia

Definitions and symptoms of retrograde and anterograde amnesia.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-MEM-03

1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

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8 Ivana is a psychologist who has been sent a patient who may have developed retrograde amnesia in the past six months.

To assess whether the patient has retrograde amnesia, Ivana decides to give the patient a test. The test involves giving the patient a set of photographs of 20 famous people who appeared in the news regularly for a five-year period prior to the test.

(a) Explain what Ivana is likely to find if the patient has retrograde amnesia.

You should refer to retrograde amnesia in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could have been made to the test Ivana gave to the patient with potential retrograde amnesia.

(4)

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(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

2. Question 9 · part a · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

9 Dekota wanted to investigate the difference between retrograde and anterograde amnesia.

She asked one participant with retrograde amnesia and one participant with anterograde amnesia to perform two tasks and recorded their performance.

Task 1: A complex picture was shown to the participants. The participants were asked to reproduce the picture after a 15-minute delay. The reproduction of the picture was scored out of 36.

Task 2: Participants were asked 100 factual questions about real news events that occurred before they suffered from amnesia.

Dekota compared the performance of her two participants with a control participant who did not suffer from amnesia.

Table 1 shows Dekota's results.

	Task 1 Picture task (score out of 36)	Task 2 News events task (score out of 100)
Participant with retrograde amnesia	26	40
Participant with anterograde amnesia	8	80
Control participant with no amnesia	33	97

Table 1

(a) Explain **two** conclusions Dekota could make from the data in **Table 1**.

(4)

Conclusion one:

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2. Question 9 · part a · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

Conclusion two:

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Dekota's study.

(4)

Strength:

Weakness:

(Total for Question 9 = 8 marks)

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2. Question 9 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

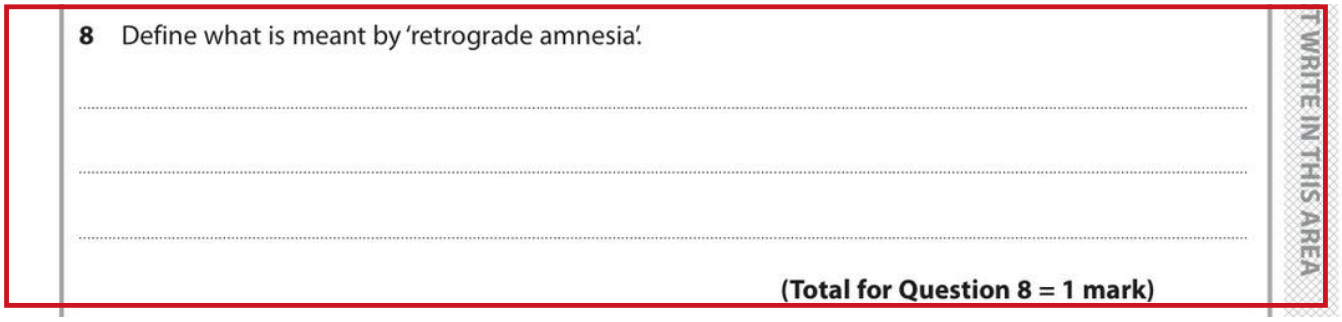
Working and answer

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3. Question 8 · part whole · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



Working and answer

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4. Question 11 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

11 Lydia wants to investigate the effects of a new painkiller on memory. She wants to see if the new painkiller affects people's ability to remember new information. Lydia recruits male participants from her local town for her investigation.

Lydia has two conditions:

- No painkiller – The male participants are shown three pictures. One hour later, the participants have to pick the three pictures from a selection of nine pictures.
- Painkiller – The same male participants are given the new painkiller. The participants are shown three new pictures. One hour later, the participants have to pick the three pictures from a selection of nine pictures.

Lydia's results are shown in **Table 2**.

Condition	Average number of pictures correctly recognised (out of 3)
No painkiller	2.9
Painkiller	1.1

Table 2

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made using the data in **Table 2**. **(2)**

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4. Question 11 · part a · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement Lydia could make to her investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 11 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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5. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

8 Lucía is concerned about her partner who has had a fall and hit their head. They have been very confused since the fall and Lucía has arranged for a psychological evaluation to see if her partner has anterograde amnesia.

Lucía's partner is given a test by the psychologist to determine whether they have anterograde amnesia. The psychologist gives Lucía's partner 10 news events that were reported on social media since their fall and asks them to recall everything they can about the events.

(a) Explain what the psychologist is likely to find if Lucía's partner has anterograde amnesia.

You should refer to anterograde amnesia in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to the test the psychologist gave to Lucía's partner.

(2)

(Total for Question 8 = 4 marks)

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5. Question 8 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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